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Tunable low cost network

Abstract

Aspects of the subject disclosure may include, for example, a method comprising providing services over a network to a device, and constructing device capability and usage profiles. A level of service quality for the device is adjusted by adjusting a latency criterion regarding connection of the device to the network; adjusting a speed of transmissions to or from the device; and altering a routing of transmissions to or from the device. The network can be partitioned so that the adjusted service quality level is provided by a network portion having a predetermined level of resources. The adjusted service quality level can comprise a first level while the device is active and a second level while the device is inactive; the first level is higher than the second level. The first and second levels are lower than a service quality level provided by another network portion. Other embodiments are disclosed.

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Background/Summary

CROSS REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATIONS (1) This application is a continuation of U.S. application Ser. No. 17/227,767, filed Apr. 12, 2021, which is a continuation of U.S. application Ser. No. 16/421,012, filed May 23, 2019 (now U.S. Pat. No. 11,005,743, issued on May 11, 2021), which is a continuation of U.S. application Ser. No. 15/188,254, filed Jun. 21, 2016 (now U.S. Pat. No. 10,341,209, issued on Jul. 2, 2019), which are incorporated herein by reference in their entirety.

FIELD OF THE DISCLOSURE

(1) The subject disclosure relates to a communication network that connects to a variety of devices

and provides network services to those devices at reduced cost.

BACKGROUND

(2) A very wide variety of devices with differing device capabilities may connect to a communication network at various times and for various purposes (for example, a sensor periodically transmitting small amounts of data to a computing device). A network that includes such devices is sometimes referred to as the “Internet of things” (IOT).

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

(1) Reference will now be made to the accompanying drawings, which are not necessarily drawn to scale, and wherein:

(2) FIG. 1 schematically illustrates IOT devices connecting to a tunable network, according to an embodiment of the disclosure;

(3) FIG. 2 depicts network utilization in a case where a device with allowable latency connects to the network of FIG. 1;

(4) FIG. 3 schematically illustrates IOT devices connecting to a partitioned network, according to an embodiment of the disclosure;

(5) FIG. 4 shows a flowchart illustrating a method for configuring a tunable network to provide services to IOT devices, according to an embodiment of the disclosure;

(6) FIG. 5 shows a flowchart illustrating a procedure in which a device is in active and inactive states over a period of time, according to an embodiment of the disclosure;

(7) FIGS. 6-7 depict illustrative embodiments of communication systems that provide media services using the networks of FIGS. 1-3;

(8) FIG. 8 depicts an illustrative embodiment of a web portal for interacting with communication systems as shown in FIGS. 1 and 3;

(9) FIG. 9 depicts an illustrative embodiment of a communication device; and

(10) FIG. 10 is a diagrammatic representation of a machine in the form of a computer system within which a set of instructions, when executed, may cause the machine to perform any one or more of the methods described herein.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

(11) The subject disclosure describes, among other things, illustrative embodiments for a communication network connected to multiple diverse devices that require different network services and whose requirements also change with time, and a method for configuring the network to meet those requirements. The network services can be dynamically adjusted for each end-user device to provide the required services at minimum cost. The exemplary embodiments described herein are related to methods and/or systems described in U.S. application Ser. No. 14/515,004 (U.S. Patent Application Publication No. 2016/0113025), the disclosure of which is hereby incorporated by reference. Other embodiments are described in the subject disclosure.

(12) One or more aspects of the subject disclosure include a method comprising providing, by a processing system including a processor, communications services over a network to a user device; obtaining information regarding capabilities of the user device; and obtaining information regarding a usage profile of the user device. The usage profile can include a periodic time interval during which the user device is in an active state; the user device is in an inactive state at other times. The method can also comprise adjusting a level of service quality provided to the user device, in accordance with at least one of the capabilities and the usage profile. The adjusting can be performed by at least one of adjusting a latency criterion regarding connection of the user device to the network; adjusting a speed of transmissions over the network to or from the user device; and altering a routing of transmissions to or from the user device. In this method, the network can be

partitioned so that the adjusted level of service quality is provided by a first portion of the network having a predetermined level of network resources. The adjusted level of service quality can comprise a first level while the user device is in the active state and a second level while the user device is in the inactive state; the first level is higher than the second level. The first level and the second level are lower than a level of service quality provided by a second portion of the network.

(13) One or more aspects of the subject disclosure include a device comprising a processing system including a processor and a memory that stores executable instructions. The instructions, when executed by the processing system, facilitate performance of operations. The operations can comprise providing communications services over a network to a user device; obtaining information regarding capabilities of the user device; and obtaining information regarding a usage profile of the user device. The usage profile can include a periodic time interval during which the user device is in an active state; the user device is in an inactive state at other times. The operations can also comprise adjusting a level of service quality provided to the user device, in accordance with at least one of the capabilities and the usage profile. The level of service quality can be adjusted by performing at least one of adjusting a latency criterion regarding connection of the user device to the network, adjusting a permitted number of transmissions from the user device per unit time, and altering a routing of transmissions to or from the user device. The network can be partitioned so that the adjusted level of service quality is provided by a first portion of the network having a predetermined level of network resources; the adjusted level of service quality can comprise a first level while the user device is in the active state and a second level while the user device is in the inactive state; the first level is higher than the second level. The first level and the second level are lower than a level of service quality provided by a second portion of the network.

(14) One or more aspects of the subject disclosure include a machine-readable storage medium comprising executable instructions that, when executed by a processing system including a processor, facilitate performance of operations. The operations can comprise providing communications services over a network to a user device; obtaining information regarding capabilities of the user device; and obtaining information regarding a usage profile of the user device. The usage profile can include a periodic time interval during which the user device is in an active state; the user device is in an inactive state at other times. The operations can also comprise adjusting a level of service quality provided to the user device, in accordance with at least one of the capabilities and the usage profile. The level of service quality can be adjusted by performing at least one of adjusting a latency criterion regarding connection of the user device to the network; adjusting an assigned ratio of uplink to downlink transmissions performed by the user device; and altering a routing of transmissions to or from the user device. The network can be partitioned so that the adjusted level of service quality is provided by a first portion of the network having a predetermined level of network resources; the adjusted level of service quality can comprise a first level while the user device is in the active state and a second level while the user device is in the inactive state; the first level is higher than the second level. The first level and the second level are lower than a level of service quality provided by a second portion of the network.

(15) FIG. 1 schematically illustrates an arrangement **100** in which IOT devices connect to a tunable network, according to an embodiment of the disclosure. As shown in FIG. 1, the IOT devices **110** can include cameras, temperature sensors, humidity sensors, motion sensors, gas/vapor detectors, etc. In general, IOT devices transmit data representing some aspect of their immediate environment; in normal operation they might or might not interact with a user. In this embodiment, a set of different IOT devices communicate over various data paths (shown for simplicity as one wireless path **120**) with a tunable network **150**. Network **150** may be configured to provide each IOT device with communication services appropriate to capability and usage profiles of the device, as detailed below.

(16) In an embodiment, network **150** is coupled to a server **160** that can manage the network to reduce cost (for example, limiting or delaying transmissions to the IOT devices during times of

network congestion). The combination of network **150** and server **160** may be viewed as a processing system **101** that is aware of IOT devices connected to the network, and can configure network connections dynamically and/or on demand to provide services to the IOT devices. In an embodiment, server **160** can cause the network **150** to provide more or fewer resources to an IOT device or a group of IOT devices to meet specific customer needs. In an embodiment, the system can comprise a home subscriber server (HSS). In general, network **150** can be configured dynamically to direct traffic to, and receive traffic from, IOT devices while controlling the cost of provisioning and serving the devices.

(17) In an embodiment, network **150** is continuously monitored in order to assess its available capacity to serve one or more of the IOT devices **110**. In general, the cost of serving the IOT devices is lower during periods of relatively lower utilization (that is, periods of relatively higher available capacity).

(18) FIG. 2 depicts a graph **200** showing how network utilization can vary with time, in accordance with an embodiment of the disclosure. In an embodiment, the relative cost of operating an IOT device corresponds to the latency tolerance of that device. For example, as shown in FIG. 2, a device might attempt to connect to the network to transmit traffic at time $t=0$, when network utilization is relatively high. If the device has a latency tolerance of (for example) 0.5 sec or less, the network may require additional resources to respond to the device. Handling traffic from the device in this situation will therefore be relatively costly.

(19) If the device can tolerate greater latency (that is, the system can delay responding to the device), traffic from the device can be handled at reduced cost. For example, as shown in FIG. 2, if the device attempts a connection at $t=0$ but has a latency tolerance LT of 2 sec, the system can delay its response until $t=2$ sec when network utilization is approximately one-third of that at $t=0$. In an embodiment, network **150** offers connections for latency-tolerant devices so that the system can prioritize other traffic and process the IOT's traffic at times of reduced congestion.

(20) In an embodiment, the system handles traffic to and from IOT devices during periods of reduced network utilization. If a device attempts to access the network while the network is congested, the system can retrieve historical data for network utilization, predict a future time of relatively low utilization, and transmit a signal to the device suggesting a time when the device should retry connecting.

(21) In an embodiment, the network includes base stations for handling wireless communications to and from the IOT devices; the base stations include computing devices to monitor traffic to and from the IOT devices. In this embodiment, a base station can predict a future time interval having reduced network utilization and delay communications with a device, subject to the device's latency tolerance.

(22) FIG. 3 schematically illustrates an arrangement **300** in which IOT devices connect to a partitioned network, according to an embodiment of the disclosure. As shown in FIG. 3, system **301** includes a partitioned network **350** and server **360**. The partitions **351-355** of network **350** include a low-cost partition **355** having fewer resources than partitions **351-354**. In an embodiment, IOT devices having a higher tolerance for delay can be assigned to connect with nodes in the low-cost partition **355**. In another embodiment, partitioning of network **350** is performed dynamically as IOT devices are added or removed, so that each IOT device is provisioned with appropriate resources and can thus operate at a reduced cost. In another embodiment, a partition other than the low-cost partition may be selected for connecting to the IOT devices (or a selected set of the IOT devices), so that a desired quality of service level is provided.

(23) FIG. 4 depicts an illustrative embodiment of a method **400** for configuring a tunable network to provide services to IOT devices. In this embodiment, one or more IOT devices, belonging to a customer subscribing to the network, transmit data over the network. In step **402**, a system (for example, processing system **301**) detects an IOT device connected on the network. The system then discovers characteristics and capabilities of the IOT device, and builds a profile for the device (step

404). In an embodiment, a data transmission from the device includes an identifier for the device, which permits the system to determine the device characteristics. For example, the device may be characterized by a latency tolerance which is indexed to the identifier and stored in a database; the database can be remote from the server **360** and accessible via the network **350**. The system also builds a usage profile for the device (step **406**), based on historical network traffic data. In an embodiment, the device transmits data only periodically; the device thus is in an active state for relatively brief, recurring periods of time, and is in an inactive state at other times.

(24) The system then configures the network (step **408**) to provide a level of service quality to the device that best matches the device profiles and the customer's cost preferences. For example, the system can specify an allowable delay for handling traffic from the device in accordance with a latency tolerance of the device, as shown in FIG. **2**. The system can also prescribe a maximum speed for data transmissions to or from the device. In an embodiment, the system provisions the device to use a particular access point name (APN) which has a restriction on speed, allows a certain latency, etc. The system can also limit the device to a certain number of transmissions per unit time. In an embodiment, this limitation itself changes with time, in accordance with an expected state (active/inactive) of the device.

(25) The system can also establish a routing for the device so that traffic to or from the device is routed to a network node (or other part of the system) designed to accommodate a relatively large number of devices processing relatively few transactions. (In an embodiment, this is done by partitioning the network to identify nodes with relatively low performance per device that can connect to a relatively large number of devices.) In a particular embodiment, the device is routed to an HSS node with greater latency tolerance than other nodes. In a further embodiment, the system (functioning as a service provider) dynamically downgrades the level of service in order to reach a cost level previously set by the customer.

(26) The system can also assign or restrict a ratio of uplink transmissions to downlink transmissions performed by the device. In an embodiment, the IOT device traffic is primarily uplink (for example, the IOT device is a sensor that typically sends sensory data and only occasionally receives control data). The system then can recognize that such a device can use spare uplink capacity, which can sometimes be available at reduced cost.

(27) In an embodiment, the system can provision the IOT device to receive network services according to a specific quality of service class identifier (QCI). The system can also be configured according to selections **407** transmitted from customer equipment; the service level for the IOT device (or a set of devices of the customer) can thus be changed on demand.

(28) In an embodiment, the system monitors network utilization and thus is aware of when the network has spare capacity for handling IOT device traffic. In this embodiment, the system can enable IOT device transmissions only when there is a certain level of excess capacity available.

(29) The system then partitions the network (step **410**) so that IOT devices are connected to a portion of the network that delivers a level of service (with a cost of service) appropriate to the characteristics and usage of the devices. In an embodiment, the appropriate level of service for a device depends on whether the device is in an active or inactive state (for example, depending on whether periodic transmission of data is occurring or expected to occur).

(30) If the IOT device is determined to be in an active state (step **412**), the system provides a level of service according to the network configuration; in an embodiment, this corresponds to a first level of service provided by the low-cost partition of the network (step **414**) and is a lower level of service than provided by other portions of the network. If the IOT device is determined to be in the inactive state, a second level of service lower than the first level is provided (step **416**).

(31) If the system determines (step **418**) that a higher level of service is needed, the device connection can be re-routed to a network node with higher performance (step **420**). For example, the system can provision an IOT device with a performance upgrade, temporarily requiring a higher level of service to the device. In this embodiment, the system can re-assign the device to a

different node for accessing the network or to a different network partition, to ensure that the upgrade is performed efficiently. In another embodiment, the customer can select a new network configuration so that the IOT devices can handle an increased volume of traffic.

(32) FIG. 5 shows a flowchart illustrating a procedure **500** in which an IOT device is in active and inactive states over a period of time, according to an embodiment of the disclosure. In this embodiment, it is desired to test the connectivity of the device (step **502**) when it is manufactured or is installed in a larger device (for example, a diagnostic sensor being installed in an automobile). The connectivity of the device is thus tested during the manufacturing process (step **504**), but can then become dormant while moving through the supply chain (step **506**). In this embodiment, a substantial length of time (>1 year) can elapse while the device remains in an inactive state, and the cost to support the device is relatively low throughout this period of time. For example, the device can be included in customer equipment (such as an automobile) and be provisioned with an international mobile subscriber identity (IMSI) profile that does not correspond to the location of the device and/or the data carrier used by the customer. However, when the device roams into the carrier's coverage area or the customer changes the carrier contract (steps **508-510**), the device can enter its active state (step **512**). In an embodiment, the system locates the device and builds or updates the device's characteristic and usage profiles. In another embodiment, the device includes a storage medium with an identifier and profiles for the device, so that it can connect with the low-cost partition of the network and begin to transmit sensor data. In another embodiment, an IOT device included in new equipment transitions from its inactive state to its active state when that equipment is put into use for the first time, independent of location or movement of the equipment.

(33) If the device does not require a higher level of service (step **514**), the device connects (or remains connected) to the low-cost partition of the network (step **516**). In an embodiment, the system establishes a low-cost network partition that serves as a default access point for all IOT devices (which in this embodiment can be defined as devices with a specified maximum volume of data per transmission and/or a specified maximum number of transmissions per unit time). If the device requires a higher level of service (for example, an update for the device was prescribed while the device was in its inactive state), the system can dynamically adjust the routing of the device to a different node or a different partition of the network (step **518**).

(34) While for purposes of simplicity of explanation, the respective processes are shown and described as a series of blocks in FIGS. 4-5, it is to be understood and appreciated that the claimed subject matter is not limited by the order of the blocks, as some blocks may occur in different orders and/or concurrently with other blocks from what is depicted and described herein. Moreover, not all illustrated blocks may be required to implement the methods described herein.

(35) FIG. 6 depicts an illustrative embodiment of a first communication system **600** for delivering media content. Communication system **600** can be overlaid or operably coupled with system **100** of FIG. 1 and/or system **300** of FIG. 3 as another representative embodiment of communication system **600**. For instance, one or both of networks **618**, **632** shown in FIG. 6 can be tunable as described above, and thus function as a tunable network **150**, **350**. In particular embodiments, one or more devices illustrated in the communication system **600** of FIG. 6 can comprise a processing system that facilitates performance of operations; the operations can comprise providing communications services over a network to a user device; obtaining information regarding capabilities of the user device; and obtaining information regarding a usage profile of the user device. The usage profile can include a periodic time interval during which the user device is in an active state; the user device is in an inactive state at other times. The operations can also comprise adjusting a level of service quality provided to the user device, in accordance with at least one of the capabilities and the usage profile. The level of service quality can be adjusted by performing at least one of adjusting a latency criterion regarding connection of the user device to the network, adjusting a permitted number of transmissions from the user device per unit time, and altering a routing of transmissions to or from the user device. The network can be partitioned so that the

adjusted level of service quality is provided by a first portion of the network having a predetermined level of network resources; the adjusted level of service quality can comprise a first level while the user device is in the active state and a second level while the user device is in the inactive state; the first level is higher than the second level. The first level and the second level are lower than a level of service quality provided by a second portion of the network.

(36) The communication system **600** can represent an Internet Protocol Television (IPTV) media system that can include a super head-end office (SHO) **610** with at least one super headend office server (SHS) **611** which receives media content from satellite and/or terrestrial communication systems. In the present context, media content can represent, for example, audio content, moving image content such as 2D or 3D videos, video games, virtual reality content, still image content, and combinations thereof. The SHS server **611** can forward packets associated with the media content to one or more video head-end servers (VHS) **614** via a network of video head-end offices (VHO) **612** according to a multicast communication protocol.

(37) The VHS **614** can distribute multimedia broadcast content via an access network **618** to commercial and/or residential buildings **602** housing a gateway **604** (such as a residential or commercial gateway). The access network **618** can represent a group of digital subscriber line access multiplexers (DSLAMs) located in a central office or a service area interface that provide broadband services over fiber optical links or copper twisted pairs **619** to buildings **602**. The gateway **604** can use communication technology to distribute broadcast signals to media processors **606** such as Set-Top Boxes (STBs) which in turn present broadcast channels to media devices **608** such as computers or television sets managed in some instances by a media controller **607** (such as an infrared or RF remote controller). In an embodiment, a device communicating with gateway **604** (for example, media device **608**) can function as an IOT device as described above.

(38) The gateway **604**, the media processors **606**, and media devices **608** can utilize tethered communication technologies (such as coaxial, powerline or phone line wiring) or can operate over a wireless access protocol such as Wireless Fidelity (WiFi), Bluetooth®, Zigbee®, or other present or next generation local or personal area wireless network technologies. By way of these interfaces, unicast communications can also be invoked between the media processors **606** and subsystems of the IPTV media system for services such as video-on-demand (VoD), browsing an electronic programming guide (EPG), or other infrastructure services.

(39) A satellite broadcast television system **629** can be used in the media system of FIG. 6. The satellite broadcast television system can be overlaid, operably coupled with, or replace the IPTV system as another representative embodiment of communication system **600**. In this embodiment, signals transmitted by a satellite **615** that include media content can be received by a satellite dish receiver **631** coupled to the building **602**. Modulated signals received by the satellite dish receiver **631** can be transferred to the media processors **606** for demodulating, decoding, encoding, and/or distributing broadcast channels to the media devices **608**. The media processors **606** can be equipped with a broadband port to a network **632** to enable interactive services such as VoD and EPG as described above.

(40) In yet another embodiment, an analog or digital cable broadcast distribution system such as cable TV system **633** can be overlaid, operably coupled with, or replace the IPTV system and/or the satellite TV system as another representative embodiment of communication system **600**. In this embodiment, the cable TV system **633** can also provide Internet, telephony, and interactive media services. It will be appreciated that system **600** can enable various types of IOT devices, as well as interactive television devices and/or services including IPTV, cable and/or satellite.

(41) The subject disclosure can apply to other present or next generation over-the-air and/or landline media content services system.

(42) Some of the network elements of the IPTV media system can be coupled to one or more computing devices **630**, a portion of which can operate as a web server for providing web portal services over the ISP network **632** to wireline media devices **608** or wireless communication

devices **616**. In particular, computing device **630** can communicate with, and provide services to, IOT device **641** via network **632**.

(43) Communication system **600** can also provide for all or a portion of the computing devices **630** to function as a server communicatively coupled to networks **150** or **350**, or as a network manager for networks **150** or **350** (herein referred to as server **630**). The server **630** can use computing and communication technology to provision IOT devices, which can include among other things, the techniques described in methods **400-500** of FIGS. **4-5**. For instance, device routing performed by server **630** can be similar to routing by servers **160** and **360** of FIGS. **1** and **3** in accordance with methods **400** and **500**. The media processors **606** and wireless communication devices **616** can be provisioned with software functions to utilize the services of server **630**. For instance, media processors **606** and wireless communication devices **616** can be used to transmit customer selections **407** to system **301**.

(44) Multiple forms of media services can be offered to media devices over landline technologies such as those described above. Additionally, media services can be offered to media devices by way of a wireless access base station **617** operating according to common wireless access protocols such as Global System for Mobile or GSM, Code Division Multiple Access or CDMA, Time Division Multiple Access or TDMA, Universal Mobile Telecommunications or UMTS, World interoperability for Microwave or WiMAX, Software Defined Radio or SDR, Long Term Evolution or LTE, and so on. Other present and next generation wide area wireless access network technologies can be used in one or more embodiments of the subject disclosure.

(45) FIG. **7** depicts an illustrative embodiment of a communication system **700** employing an IP Multimedia Subsystem (IMS) network architecture to facilitate the combined services of circuit-switched and packet-switched systems. Communication system **700** can be overlaid or operably coupled with system **100** of FIG. **1** and/or system **300** of FIG. **3** and communication system **600** as another representative embodiment of communication system **600**. In particular, server **630** (also shown in FIG. **6**) can communicate with IOT device **641** either directly or via network **632**; in the embodiment shown in FIG. **7**, server **630** communicates with network **632** via IMS network **750**, which itself may be a tunable network as described above. Accordingly, elements of system **700** can perform a method comprising providing, by a processing system including a processor, communications services over a network to a user device; obtaining information regarding capabilities of the user device; and obtaining information regarding a usage profile of the user device. The usage profile can include a periodic time interval during which the user device is in an active state; the user device is in an inactive state at other times. The method can also comprise adjusting a level of service quality provided to the user device, in accordance with at least one of the capabilities and the usage profile. The adjusting can be performed by at least one of adjusting a latency criterion regarding connection of the user device to the network; adjusting a speed of transmissions over the network to or from the user device; and altering a routing of transmissions to or from the user device. In this method, the network can be partitioned so that the adjusted level of service quality is provided by a first portion of the network having a predetermined level of network resources. The adjusted level of service quality can comprise a first level while the user device is in the active state and a second level while the user device is in the inactive state; the first level is higher than the second level. The first level and the second level are lower than a level of service quality provided by a second portion of the network.

(46) Communication system **700** can comprise a Home Subscriber Server (HSS) **740**, a tElephone NUMber Mapping (ENUM) server **730**, and other network elements of an IMS network **750**. The IMS network **750** can establish communications between IMS-compliant communication devices (CDs) **701**, **702**, Public Switched Telephone Network (PSTN) CDs **703**, **705**, and combinations thereof by way of a Media Gateway Control Function (MGCF) **720** coupled to a PSTN network **760**. The MGCF **720** need not be used when a communication session involves IMS CD to IMS CD communications. A communication session involving at least one PSTN CD may utilize the

MGCF **720**.

(47) IMS CDs **701**, **702** can register with the IMS network **750** by contacting a Proxy Call Session Control Function (P-CSCF) which communicates with an interrogating CSCF (I-CSCF), which in turn, communicates with a Serving CSCF (S-CSCF) to register the CDs with the HSS **740**. To initiate a communication session between CDs, an originating IMS CD **701** can submit a Session Initiation Protocol (SIP INVITE) message to an originating P-CSCF **704** which communicates with a corresponding originating S-CSCF **706**. The originating S-CSCF **706** can submit the SIP INVITE message to one or more application servers (ASs) **717** that can provide a variety of services to IMS subscribers.

(48) For example, the application servers **717** can be used to perform originating call feature treatment functions on the calling party number received by the originating S-CSCF **706** in the SIP INVITE message. Originating treatment functions can include determining whether the calling party number has international calling services, call ID blocking, calling name blocking, 7-digit dialing, and/or is requesting special telephony features (e.g., *72 forward calls, *73 cancel call forwarding, *67 for caller ID blocking, and so on). Based on initial filter criteria (iFCs) in a subscriber profile associated with a CD, one or more application servers may be invoked to provide various call originating feature services.

(49) Additionally, the originating S-CSCF **706** can submit queries to the ENUM system **730** to translate an E.164 telephone number in the SIP INVITE message to a SIP Uniform Resource Identifier (URI) if the terminating communication device is IMS-compliant. The SIP URI can be used by an Interrogating CSCF (I-CSCF) **707** to submit a query to the HSS **740** to identify a terminating S-CSCF **714** associated with a terminating IMS CD such as reference **702**. Once identified, the I-CSCF **707** can submit the SIP INVITE message to the terminating S-CSCF **714**. The terminating S-CSCF **714** can then identify a terminating P-CSCF **716** associated with the terminating CD **702**. The P-CSCF **716** may then signal the CD **702** to establish Voice over Internet Protocol (VoIP) communication services, thereby enabling the calling and called parties to engage in voice and/or data communications. Based on the iFCs in the subscriber profile, one or more application servers may be invoked to provide various call terminating feature services, such as call forwarding, do not disturb, music tones, simultaneous ringing, sequential ringing, etc.

(50) In some instances the aforementioned communication process is symmetrical. Accordingly, the terms “originating” and “terminating” in FIG. 7 may be interchangeable. It is further noted that communication system **700** can be adapted to support video conferencing. In addition, communication system **700** can be adapted to provide the IMS CDs **701**, **702** with the multimedia and Internet services of communication system **600** of FIG. 6.

(51) If the terminating communication device is instead a PSTN CD such as CD **703** or CD **705** (in instances where the cellular phone only supports circuit-switched voice communications), the ENUM system **730** can respond with an unsuccessful address resolution which can cause the originating S-CSCF **706** to forward the call to the MGCF **720** via a Breakout Gateway Control Function (BGCF) **719**. The MGCF **720** can then initiate the call to the terminating PSTN CD over the PSTN network **760** to enable the calling and called parties to engage in voice and/or data communications.

(52) It is further appreciated that the CDs of FIG. 7 can operate as wireline or wireless devices. For example, the CDs of FIG. 7 can be communicatively coupled to a cellular base station **721**, a femtocell, a WiFi router, a Digital Enhanced Cordless Telecommunications (DECT) base unit, or another suitable wireless access unit to establish communications with the IMS network **750** of FIG. 7. The cellular access base station **721** can operate according to common wireless access protocols such as GSM, CDMA, TDMA, UMTS, WiMax, SDR, LTE, and so on. Other present and next generation wireless network technologies can be used by one or more embodiments of the subject disclosure. Accordingly, multiple wireline and wireless communication technologies can be used by the CDs of FIG. 7.

(53) Cellular phones supporting LTE can support packet-switched voice and packet-switched data communications and thus may operate as IMS-compliant mobile devices. In this embodiment, the cellular base station **721** may communicate directly with the IMS network **750** as shown by the arrow connecting the cellular base station **721** and the P-CSCF **716**.

(54) Alternative forms of a CSCF can operate in a device, system, component, or other form of centralized or distributed hardware and/or software. Indeed, a respective CSCF may be embodied as a respective CSCF system having one or more computers or servers, either centralized or distributed, where each computer or server may be configured to perform or provide, in whole or in part, any method, step, or functionality described herein in accordance with a respective CSCF. Likewise, other functions, servers and computers described herein, including but not limited to, the HSS, the ENUM server, the BGCF, and the MGCF, can be embodied in a respective system having one or more computers or servers, either centralized or distributed, where each computer or server may be configured to perform or provide, in whole or in part, any method, step, or functionality described herein in accordance with a respective function, server, or computer.

(55) The server **630** of FIG. **6** can be operably coupled to communication system **700** for purposes similar to those described above. Server **630** can perform device provisioning and data traffic handling services to the CDs **701**, **702**, **703** and **705** of FIG. **7** similar to the functions described for servers **160** and **360** of FIGS. **1** and **3** in accordance with methods **400-500** of FIGS. **4-5**. CDs **701**, **702**, **703** and **705** can be adapted with software to utilize the services of the server **630**. Server **630** can be an integral part of the application server(s) **717**, which can be adapted to the operations of the IMS network **750**. In an embodiment, network **750** can be a tunable network as described above, while communication devices **701-703** can function as, or include, IOT devices communicating with the tunable network.

(56) For illustration purposes only, the terms S-CSCF, P-CSCF, I-CSCF, and so on, can be server devices, but may be referred to in the subject disclosure without the word “server.” It is also understood that any form of a CSCF server can operate in a device, system, component, or other form of centralized or distributed hardware and software. It is further noted that these terms and other terms such as DIAMETER commands are terms can include features, methodologies, and/or fields that may be described in whole or in part by standards bodies such as 3GPP. It is further noted that some or all embodiments of the subject disclosure may in whole or in part modify, supplement, or otherwise supersede final or proposed standards published and promulgated by 3GPP.

(57) FIG. **8** depicts an illustrative embodiment of a web portal **802** of a communication system **800**. Communication system **800** can be overlaid or operably coupled with system **100** of FIG. **1** and/or system **300** of FIG. **3**, communication system **600**, and/or communication system **700** as another representative embodiment of system **100**, system **300**, communication system **600**, and/or communication system **700**. For example, web portal **802** can provide access to a variety of devices **810** including communication devices and/or IOT devices. The web portal **802** can thus be used for managing services of system **100** and/or system **300** and communication systems **600-700**. A web page of the web portal **802** can be accessed by a Uniform Resource Locator (URL) with an Internet browser using an Internet-capable communication device such as those described in FIGS. **1-3**, **6** and **7**. In an embodiment, the web portal **802** comprises an enterprise portal that can access IOT devices suitable for a commercial environment (temperature sensors, humidity sensors, etc.) In other embodiments, the web portal **802** can be configured, for example, to access a media processor **606** and services managed thereby such as a Digital Video Recorder (DVR), a Video on Demand (VoD) catalog, an Electronic Programming Guide (EPG), or a personal catalog (such as personal videos, pictures, audio recordings, etc.) stored at the media processor **606**. The web portal **802** can also be used for provisioning IMS services described earlier, provisioning Internet services, provisioning cellular phone services, and so on.

(58) The web portal **802** can further be utilized to manage and provision software applications in a

software defined network (SDN) to adapt these applications as may be desired by subscribers and/or service providers of systems **100** and **300**, and communication systems **600-700**. For instance, users of the services provided by servers **160**, **360** or **630** can log into their on-line accounts and provision the servers **160**, **360** or **630** with profiles of IOT devices, provide contact information to the server to enable it to communicate with the devices described in FIGS. **1-5**, and so on. Service providers can log onto an administrator account to provision, monitor and/or maintain systems **100** or **300**, or server **630**.

(59) FIG. **9** depicts an illustrative embodiment of a communication device **900**. Communication device **900** can serve in whole or in part as an illustrative embodiment of the devices depicted in FIGS. **1** and/or **3**, and FIGS. **4-5** and can be configured to perform portions of method **400** and/or method **500** of FIGS. **4** and **5**. In particular, device **900** can be configured as an IOT device that includes a subset of the components shown in FIG. **9** (for example, a combination of a transceiver, motion sensor, orientation sensor, controller, and power supply). In a specific IOT device, the sensors can instead comprise sensors for one or more of light, sound, temperature, humidity, pressure, etc. For example, an IOT device can include a sensor **918**, a controller **906** and a transceiver **902**.

(60) Communication device **900** can comprise a wireline and/or wireless transceiver **902** (herein transceiver **902**), a user interface (UI) **904**, a power supply **914**, a location receiver **916**, a motion sensor **918**, an orientation sensor **920**, and a controller **906** for managing operations thereof. The transceiver **902** can support short-range or long-range wireless access technologies such as Bluetooth®, ZigBee®, WiFi, DECT, or cellular communication technologies, just to mention a few (Bluetooth® and ZigBee® are trademarks registered by the Bluetooth® Special Interest Group and the ZigBee® Alliance, respectively). Cellular technologies can include, for example, CDMA-1X, UMTS/HSDPA, GSM/GPRS, TDMA/EDGE, EV/DO, WiMAX, SDR, LTE, as well as other next generation wireless communication technologies as they arise. The transceiver **902** can also be adapted to support circuit-switched wireline access technologies (such as PSTN), packet-switched wireline access technologies (such as TCP/IP, VoIP, etc.), and combinations thereof.

(61) The UI **904** can include a depressible or touch-sensitive keypad **908** with a navigation mechanism such as a roller ball, a joystick, a mouse, or a navigation disk for manipulating operations of the communication device **900**. The keypad **908** can be an integral part of a housing assembly of the communication device **900** or an independent device operably coupled thereto by a tethered wireline interface (such as a USB cable) or a wireless interface supporting for example Bluetooth®. The keypad **908** can represent a numeric keypad commonly used by phones, and/or a QWERTY keypad with alphanumeric keys. The UI **904** can further include a display **910** such as monochrome or color LCD (Liquid Crystal Display), OLED (Organic Light Emitting Diode) or other suitable display technology for conveying images to an end user of the communication device **900**. In an embodiment where the display **910** is touch-sensitive, a portion or all of the keypad **908** can be presented by way of the display **910** with navigation features.

(62) The display **910** can use touch screen technology to also serve as a user interface for detecting user input. As a touch screen display, the communication device **900** can be adapted to present a user interface with graphical user interface (GUI) elements that can be selected by a user with a touch of a finger. The touch screen display **910** can be equipped with capacitive, resistive or other forms of sensing technology to detect how much surface area of a user's finger has been placed on a portion of the touch screen display. This sensing information can be used to control the manipulation of the GUI elements or other functions of the user interface. The display **910** can be an integral part of the housing assembly of the communication device **900** or an independent device communicatively coupled thereto by a tethered wireline interface (such as a cable) or a wireless interface.

(63) The UI **904** can also include an audio system **912** that utilizes audio technology for conveying low volume audio (such as audio heard in proximity of a human ear) and high volume audio (such

as speakerphone for hands free operation). The audio system **912** can further include a microphone for receiving audible signals of an end user. The audio system **912** can also be used for voice recognition applications. The UI **904** can further include an image sensor **913** such as a charged coupled device (CCD) camera for capturing still or moving images.

(64) The power supply **914** can utilize common power management technologies such as replaceable and rechargeable batteries, supply regulation technologies, and/or charging system technologies for supplying energy to the components of the communication device **900** to facilitate long-range or short-range portable applications. Alternatively, or in combination, the charging system can utilize external power sources such as DC power supplied over a physical interface such as a USB port or other suitable tethering technologies.

(65) The location receiver **916** can utilize location technology such as a global positioning system (GPS) receiver capable of assisted GPS for identifying a location of the communication device **900** based on signals generated by a constellation of GPS satellites, which can be used for facilitating location services such as navigation. The motion sensor **918** can utilize motion sensing technology such as an accelerometer, a gyroscope, or other suitable motion sensing technology to detect motion of the communication device **900** in three-dimensional space. The orientation sensor **920** can utilize orientation sensing technology such as a magnetometer to detect the orientation of the communication device **900** (north, south, west, and east, as well as combined orientations in degrees, minutes, or other suitable orientation metrics).

(66) The communication device **900** can use the transceiver **902** to also determine a proximity to a cellular, WiFi, Bluetooth®, or other wireless access points by sensing techniques such as utilizing a received signal strength indicator (RSSI) and/or signal time of arrival (TOA) or time of flight (TOF) measurements. The controller **906** can utilize computing technologies such as a microprocessor, a digital signal processor (DSP), programmable gate arrays, application specific integrated circuits, and/or a video processor with associated storage memory such as Flash, ROM, RAM, SRAM, DRAM or other storage technologies for executing computer instructions, controlling, and processing data supplied by the aforementioned components of the communication device **900**.

(67) Other components not shown in FIG. **9** can be used in one or more embodiments of the subject disclosure. For instance, the communication device **900** can include a reset button (not shown). The reset button can be used to reset the controller **906** of the communication device **900**. In yet another embodiment, the communication device **900** can also include a factory default setting button positioned, for example, below a small hole in a housing assembly of the communication device **900** to force the communication device **900** to re-establish factory settings. In this embodiment, a user can use a protruding object such as a pen or paper clip tip to reach into the hole and depress the default setting button. The communication device **900** can also include a slot for adding or removing an identity module such as a Subscriber Identity Module (SIM) card. SIM cards can be used for identifying subscriber services, executing programs, storing subscriber data, and so forth.

(68) The communication device **900** as described herein can operate with more or less of the circuit components shown in FIG. **9**. These variant embodiments can be used in one or more embodiments of the subject disclosure.

(69) The communication device **900** can be adapted to perform the functions of devices of FIGS. **1** and/or **3**, the media processor **606**, the media devices **608**, or the portable communication devices **616** of FIG. **6**, as well as the IMS CDs **701-702** and PSTN CDs **703-705** of FIG. **7**. It will be appreciated that the communication device **900** can also represent other devices that can operate in systems **100**, **300**, and/or communication systems **600-700**, such as a gaming console and a media player. In addition, the controller **906** can be adapted in various embodiments to perform network monitoring and provisioning functions.

(70) Upon reviewing the aforementioned embodiments, it would be evident to an artisan with ordinary skill in the art that said embodiments can be modified, reduced, or enhanced without

departing from the scope of the claims described below. For example, in cases where IOT devices communicate over the network intermittently (e.g. sending a status report once per day), network services can be made available to such devices at pre-scheduled times, with the time of actual transmission dynamically adjusted to occur when network traffic is reduced and excess capacity is available.

(71) In another embodiment, a system provider communicates with a customer over a software-defined network to enable a communication for the customer's specific needs, which may be unique to that communication. The customer thus can obtain the desired services dynamically, as opposed to the customer using services prescribed by his rate plan. Other embodiments can be used in the subject disclosure.

(72) It should be understood that devices described in the exemplary embodiments can be in communication with each other via various wireless and/or wired methodologies. The methodologies can be links that are described as coupled, connected and so forth, which can include unidirectional and/or bidirectional communication over wireless paths and/or wired paths that utilize one or more of various protocols or methodologies, where the coupling and/or connection can be direct (e.g., no intervening processing device) and/or indirect (e.g., an intermediary processing device such as a router).

(73) FIG. 10 depicts an exemplary diagrammatic representation of a machine in the form of a computer system **1000** within which a set of instructions, when executed, may cause the machine to perform any one or more of the methods described above. One or more instances of the machine can operate, for example, as the server **160**, the server **360**, the server **630**, and other devices of FIGS. 1-5. In some embodiments, the machine may be connected (e.g., using a network **1026**) to other machines. In particular, network **1026** can be a tunable network as described above, communicating with various IOT devices. In a networked deployment, the machine may operate in the capacity of a server or a client user machine in a server-client user network environment, or as a peer machine in a peer-to-peer (or distributed) network environment.

(74) The machine may comprise a server computer, a client user computer, a personal computer (PC), a tablet, a smart phone, a laptop computer, a desktop computer, a control system, a network router, switch or bridge, or any machine capable of executing a set of instructions (sequential or otherwise) that specify actions to be taken by that machine. It will be understood that a communication device of the subject disclosure includes broadly any electronic device that provides voice, video or data communication. Further, while a single machine is illustrated, the term "machine" shall also be taken to include any collection of machines that individually or jointly execute a set (or multiple sets) of instructions to perform any one or more of the methods discussed herein.

(75) The computer system **1000** may include a processor (or controller) **1002** (e.g., a central processing unit (CPU)), a graphics processing unit (GPU, or both), a main memory **1004** and a static memory **1006**, which communicate with each other via a bus **1008**. The computer system **1000** may further include a display unit **1010** (e.g., a liquid crystal display (LCD), a flat panel, or a solid state display). The computer system **1000** may include an input device **1012** (e.g., a keyboard), a cursor control device **1014** (e.g., a mouse), a disk drive unit **1016**, a signal generation device **1018** (e.g., a speaker or remote control) and a network interface device **1020**. In distributed environments, the embodiments described in the subject disclosure can be adapted to utilize multiple display units **1010** controlled by two or more computer systems **1000**. In this configuration, presentations described by the subject disclosure may in part be shown in a first of the display units **1010**, while the remaining portion is presented in a second of the display units **1010**.

(76) The disk drive unit **1016** may include a tangible computer-readable storage medium **1022** on which is stored one or more sets of instructions (e.g., software **1024**) embodying any one or more of the methods or functions described herein, including those methods illustrated above. The

instructions **1024** may also reside, completely or at least partially, within the main memory **1004**, the static memory **1006**, and/or within the processor **1002** during execution thereof by the computer system **1000**. The main memory **1004** and the processor **1002** also may constitute tangible computer-readable storage media.

(77) Dedicated hardware implementations including, but not limited to, application specific integrated circuits, programmable logic arrays and other hardware devices can likewise be constructed to implement the methods described herein. Application specific integrated circuits and programmable logic array can use downloadable instructions for executing state machines and/or circuit configurations to implement embodiments of the subject disclosure. Applications that may include the apparatus and systems of various embodiments broadly include a variety of electronic and computer systems. Some embodiments implement functions in two or more specific interconnected hardware modules or devices with related control and data signals communicated between and through the modules, or as portions of an application-specific integrated circuit. Thus, the example system is applicable to software, firmware, and hardware implementations.

(78) In accordance with various embodiments of the subject disclosure, the operations or methods described herein are intended for operation as software programs or instructions running on or executed by a computer processor or other computing device, and which may include other forms of instructions manifested as a state machine implemented with logic components in an application specific integrated circuit or field programmable gate array. Furthermore, software implementations (e.g., software programs, instructions, etc.) including, but not limited to, distributed processing or component/object distributed processing, parallel processing, or virtual machine processing can also be constructed to implement the methods described herein. It is further noted that a computing device such as a processor, a controller, a state machine or other suitable device for executing instructions to perform operations or methods may perform such operations directly or indirectly by way of one or more intermediate devices directed by the computing device.

(79) While the tangible computer-readable storage medium **1022** is shown in an example embodiment to be a single medium, the term “tangible computer-readable storage medium” should be taken to include a single medium or multiple media (e.g., a centralized or distributed database, and/or associated caches and servers) that store the one or more sets of instructions. The term “tangible computer-readable storage medium” shall also be taken to include any non-transitory medium that is capable of storing or encoding a set of instructions for execution by the machine and that cause the machine to perform any one or more of the methods of the subject disclosure. The term “non-transitory” as in a non-transitory computer-readable storage includes without limitation memories, drives, devices and anything tangible but not a signal per se.

(80) The term “tangible computer-readable storage medium” shall accordingly be taken to include, but not be limited to: solid-state memories such as a memory card or other package that houses one or more read-only (non-volatile) memories, random access memories, or other re-writable (volatile) memories, a magneto-optical or optical medium such as a disk or tape, or other tangible media which can be used to store information. Accordingly, the disclosure is considered to include any one or more of a tangible computer-readable storage medium, as listed herein and including art-recognized equivalents and successor media, in which the software implementations herein are stored.

(81) Although the present specification describes components and functions implemented in the embodiments with reference to particular standards and protocols, the disclosure is not limited to such standards and protocols. Each of the standards for Internet and other packet switched network transmission (e.g., TCP/IP, UDP/IP, HTML, HTTP) represent examples of the state of the art. Such standards are from time-to-time superseded by faster or more efficient equivalents having essentially the same functions. Wireless standards for device detection (e.g., RFID), short-range communications (e.g., Bluetooth®, WiFi, Zigbee®), and long-range communications (e.g., WiMAX, GSM, CDMA, LTE) can be used by computer system **1000**. In one or more

embodiments, information regarding use of services can be generated including services being accessed, media consumption history, user preferences, and so forth. This information can be obtained by various methods including user input, detecting types of communications (e.g., video content vs. audio content), analysis of content streams, and so forth. The generating, obtaining and/or monitoring of this information can be responsive to an authorization provided by the user.

(82) The illustrations of embodiments described herein are intended to provide a general understanding of the structure of various embodiments, and they are not intended to serve as a complete description of all the elements and features of apparatus and systems that might make use of the structures described herein. Many other embodiments will be apparent to those of skill in the art upon reviewing the above description. The exemplary embodiments can include combinations of features and/or steps from multiple embodiments. Other embodiments may be utilized and derived therefrom, such that structural and logical substitutions and changes may be made without departing from the scope of this disclosure. Figures are also merely representational and may not be drawn to scale. Certain proportions thereof may be exaggerated, while others may be minimized. Accordingly, the specification and drawings are to be regarded in an illustrative rather than a restrictive sense.

(83) Although specific embodiments have been illustrated and described herein, it should be appreciated that any arrangement which achieves the same or similar purpose may be substituted for the embodiments described or shown by the subject disclosure. The subject disclosure is intended to cover any and all adaptations or variations of various embodiments. Combinations of the above embodiments, and other embodiments not specifically described herein, can be used in the subject disclosure. For instance, one or more features from one or more embodiments can be combined with one or more features of one or more other embodiments. In one or more embodiments, features that are positively recited can also be negatively recited and excluded from the embodiment with or without replacement by another structural and/or functional feature. The steps or functions described with respect to the embodiments of the subject disclosure can be performed in any order. The steps or functions described with respect to the embodiments of the subject disclosure can be performed alone or in combination with other steps or functions of the subject disclosure, as well as from other embodiments or from other steps that have not been described in the subject disclosure. Further, more than or less than all of the features described with respect to an embodiment can also be utilized.

(84) Less than all of the steps or functions described with respect to the exemplary processes or methods can also be performed in one or more of the exemplary embodiments. Further, the use of numerical terms to describe a device, component, step or function, such as first, second, third, and so forth, is not intended to describe an order or function unless expressly stated so. The use of the terms first, second, third and so forth, is generally to distinguish between devices, components, steps or functions unless expressly stated otherwise. Additionally, one or more devices or components described with respect to the exemplary embodiments can facilitate one or more functions, where the facilitating (e.g., facilitating access or facilitating establishing a connection) can include less than every step needed to perform the function or can include all of the steps needed to perform the function.

(85) In one or more embodiments, a processor (which can include a controller or circuit) has been described that performs various functions. It should be understood that the processor can be multiple processors, which can include distributed processors or parallel processors in a single machine or multiple machines. The processor can be used in supporting a virtual processing environment. The virtual processing environment may support one or more virtual machines representing computers, servers, or other computing devices. In such virtual machines, components such as microprocessors and storage devices may be virtualized or logically represented. The processor can include a state machine, application specific integrated circuit, and/or programmable gate array including a Field PGA. In one or more embodiments, when a processor executes

instructions to perform “operations”, this can include the processor performing the operations directly and/or facilitating, directing, or cooperating with another device or component to perform the operations.

(86) The Abstract of the Disclosure is provided with the understanding that it will not be used to interpret or limit the scope or meaning of the claims. In addition, in the foregoing Detailed Description, it can be seen that various features are grouped together in a single embodiment for the purpose of streamlining the disclosure. This method of disclosure is not to be interpreted as reflecting an intention that the claimed embodiments require more features than are expressly recited in each claim. Rather, as the following claims reflect, inventive subject matter lies in less than all features of a single disclosed embodiment. Thus the following claims are hereby incorporated into the Detailed Description, with each claim standing on its own as a separately claimed subject matter.

Claims

1. A device comprising: a processing system including a processor; and a memory that stores executable instructions that, when executed by the processing system, facilitate performance of operations comprising: obtaining information regarding a user device on a network, the information comprising capabilities of the user device and a usage profile of the user device, adjusting a level of service quality provided to the user device in accordance with at least one of the capabilities and the usage profile, resulting in an adjusted level of service quality, the adjusting comprising: specifying an allowable delay for handling communications traffic from the user device, in accordance with a latency tolerance of the user device; specifying a permitted number of transmissions from the user device per unit time, and altering a routing of the transmissions to or from the user device; and enabling the transmissions in accordance with a capacity level of the network, wherein the network is partitioned so that the adjusted level of service quality is provided by a first portion of the network having a predetermined level of network resources, the adjusted level of service quality comprising a first level while the user device is in an active state and a second level while the user device is in an inactive state, the first level being higher than the second level, and wherein the first level and the second level are lower than a level of service quality provided by a second portion of the network.
2. The device of claim 1, wherein the operations further comprise determining a level of excess capacity of the network.
3. The device of claim 2, wherein the transmissions are enabled only when the level of excess capacity exceeds a predetermined level.
4. The device of claim 1, wherein the level of service quality is reduced responsive to a request from the user device, resulting in a reduced level of service quality, and wherein the first portion of the network comprises a first node having a performance profile in accordance with the reduced level of service quality.
5. The device of claim 4, wherein the first node is configured to provide access to the network by a first number of user devices, and wherein the first number is greater than a second number of user devices accommodated at a second node in a second portion of the network.
6. The device of claim 1, wherein the operations further comprise monitoring a level of network utilization for the network.
7. The device of claim 1, wherein the adjusting further comprises adjusting a latency criterion regarding connection of the user device to the network.
8. The device of claim 7, wherein the operations further comprise providing a response to a request for connection to the network, wherein the response is delayed relative to the request in accordance with the adjusted latency criterion so that the response is provided when the level of network utilization is lower than at a time of receiving the request.

9. The device of claim 1, wherein the usage profile includes historical data regarding the transmissions over the network to or from the user device, and wherein the operations further comprise predicting a transition of the user device between the active state and the inactive state based on the historical data.

10. The device of claim 1, wherein the user device is in the active state in order to test connectivity to the network during a manufacturing process of the user device, and subsequently enters the inactive state.

11. A method comprising: obtaining, by a processing system including a processor, information regarding a user device on a network, the information comprising capabilities of the user device and a usage profile of the user device, monitoring, by the processing system, a level of network utilization for the network; adjusting, by the processing system, a level of service quality provided to the user device in accordance with at least one of the capabilities and the usage profile, resulting in an adjusted level of service quality, the adjusting comprising: specifying an allowable delay for handling communications traffic from the user device, in accordance with a latency tolerance of the user device, and altering a routing of transmissions to or from the user device; and enabling, by the processing system, the transmissions in accordance with a capacity level of the network, wherein the network is partitioned so that the adjusted level of service quality is provided by a first portion of the network having a predetermined level of network resources, the adjusted level of service quality comprising a first level while the user device is in an active state and a second level while the user device is in an inactive state, the first level being higher than the second level, and wherein the first level and the second level are lower than a level of service quality provided by a second portion of the network.

12. The method of claim 11, further comprising determining, by the processing system, a level of excess capacity of the network, wherein the transmissions are enabled only when the level of excess capacity exceeds a predetermined level.

13. The method of claim 11, wherein the level of service quality is reduced responsive to a request from the user device, resulting in a reduced level of service quality, wherein the first portion of the network comprises a first node having a performance profile in accordance with the reduced level of service quality, wherein the first node is configured to provide access to the network by a first number of user devices, and wherein the first number is greater than a second number of user devices accommodated at a second node in a second portion of the network.

14. The method of claim 11, wherein the adjusting further comprises adjusting a latency criterion regarding connection of the user device to the network, and further comprising providing, by the processing system, a response to a request for connection to the network, wherein the response is delayed relative to the request in accordance with the adjusted latency criterion.

15. The method of claim 11, wherein the user device is in the active state in order to test connectivity to the network during a manufacturing process of the user device, and subsequently enters the inactive state.

16. A non-transitory machine-readable medium comprising executable instructions that, when executed by a processing system including a processor, facilitate performance of operations comprising: obtaining information regarding a user device on a network, the information comprising capabilities of the user device and a usage profile of the user device; adjusting a level of service quality provided to the user device in accordance with at least one of the capabilities and the usage profile, resulting in an adjusted level of service quality, the adjusting comprising: specifying an allowable delay for handling communications traffic from the user device, in accordance with a latency tolerance of the user device, specifying a permitted number of transmissions over the network from the user device per unit time, and altering a routing of the transmissions to or from the user device; and enabling the transmissions in accordance with a capacity level of the network, wherein the network is partitioned so that the adjusted level of service quality is provided by a first portion of the network having a predetermined level of

network resources, the adjusted level of service quality comprising a first level while the user device is in an active state and a second level while the user device is in an inactive state, the first level being higher than the second level, wherein the first level and the second level are lower than a level of service quality provided by a second portion of the network.

17. The non-transitory machine-readable medium of claim 16, wherein the operations further comprise determining a level of excess capacity of the network, wherein the transmissions are enabled only when the level of excess capacity exceeds a predetermined level.

18. The non-transitory machine-readable medium of claim 16, wherein the level of service quality is reduced responsive to a request from the user device, resulting in a reduced level of service quality, wherein the first portion of the network comprises a first node having a performance profile in accordance with the reduced level of service quality, wherein the first node is configured to provide access to the network by a first number of user devices, and wherein the first number is greater than a second number of user devices accommodated at a second node in a second portion of the network.

19. The non-transitory machine-readable medium of claim 16, wherein the adjusting further comprises adjusting a latency criterion regarding connection of the user device to the network, and wherein the operations further comprise providing a response to a request for connection to the network, wherein the response is delayed relative to the request in accordance with the adjusted latency criterion.

20. The non-transitory machine-readable medium of claim 16, wherein the user device is in the active state in order to test connectivity to the network during a manufacturing process of the user device, and subsequently enters the inactive state.
